



Notification Waiver Determination

Goodstart Early Learning – certain Edge Early Learning centres (in administration)

Acquisition	Goodstart Early Learning Ltd (Goodstart) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of the business and assets of 31 childcare centres operated by Edge Early Learning Holdings Pty Ltd (Administrators Appointed) (Edge), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	6 October 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Goodstart, is a national provider of early learning and childcare services, operating a network of 666 childcare centres across Australia. It is a not-for-profit provider formed by The Benevolent Society, Mission Australia, the Brotherhood of St Laurence, and Social Ventures Australia. The vendor, Edge, is an Australian early childhood education provider which operates a network of 64 childcare centres across Queensland and South Australia. Edge is in voluntary administration, and the Acquisition will take place following a sale process conducted by the administrators. Both Goodstart and Edge provide centre-based childcare and early childhood education services (long day care services) for children aged 0-6 years in relevant local areas in Queensland and South Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and other relevant information available to it. The ACCC has also had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition because: in respect of 23 target Edge long day care centres, there is no geographic overlap between the target centre and any existing Goodstart centre in the relevant local areas

	b. in respect of the remaining 8 target Edge long day care centres where there is geographic overlap between the target centre and an existing Goodstart centre, Goodstart would face competition from multiple alternative providers of long day care services in the local area post-Acquisition c. absent the Acquisition, some of the target Edge centres may otherwise close, reducing or removing consumers' access to long day care services in the relevant local areas. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition and continuity of service for essential childcare services. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by a division of the Commission constituted by a direction issued pursuant to section 19 of the Act